Fight Club 2 Comic Teaser
Here's a look at the artwork teaser for the new announced Fight Club 2 comic book series **http://dgit.in/FightClub2**

Watch with Survival Kit
The Recon 6 watch packs a survival kit containing a compass, fire starter, signal mirror, flashlight and seven other things **http://dgit.in/Recon6**

like PCA and clustering, and correlational tools used to find relationships between concepts, like regressions and classifiers. Other popular techniques for more specific purposes are machine learning algorithms, which deal more with writing algorithms to allow computers to work on their own with big data, and decision trees, neural networks and deep learning,

To use these statistical models effectively, it is essential to know the assumptions underlying each one, along with knowledge of advanced Probability, both Frequentist and Bayesian, since this is what most predictive models are based on. Also, since these are computational models, you need to use software to run them, and in many cases improve them. While you could use SAS and SPSS for some of these models, these applications are more commonly used for broad enterprise and academic purposes respectively, and face constraints with respect to flexibility and customisation.

SAS is great for most statistical models, but like SPSS, its main strengths involve data mining, and using well defined run-of-the-mill statistical analyses. While these models meet most of an organisation's needs, they do not let you customise the source code in them, or help your write your own algorithms that make the models better. It assumes that you already know what you can expect from your data. This is fine for a Data Mining job in a BPO or KPO, but there is always scope for developing new models, or using existing models in new ways. For real problem solving, where you might have to come up with completely new and creative solutions and models, you will need to code.

The best coding tools you could use for advanced data modelling are programming languages like R and Python, both of which are free and open source. R is currently the most popular application used in statistical analysis. It has been around for ages and users can make use of its extensive library support, where statistical packages are just a click away. Python is gaining in popularity, but it will be some time before it amasses the library support that R has. However, being a high level language with more flexibility than R, it might be worth investing in for the long term if you are new to the field. But if you already program in R, there is no reason to switch to Python, unless you plan on developing other non-statistical applications. Matlab is popular as well, but requires purchasing a license.

Where to Study

A relevant Bachelor's/Masters degree from a good University is a must. The degree must equip you with skills in an understanding of statistics and ability to program. If not, you could always learn an open source programming language on your own, along with some ability to work with databases.

We are using increasingly complex tools to visualise data

Remember that simply mastering a tool does not make you a Data Scientist. A lot of private coaching institutes have mushroomed across the country feeding into the Big Data Analytics hype, and offering training on SAS, SQL, Hadoop, etc. However, none of these tools will make you a Data Scientist or lead to a career in Data Science without broader statistical, programming and business knowledge.

After formal education, the best place to polish your statistical and data modelling skills is online. A number of free college-level courses on Data Science are available on e-learning platforms like Coursera and EdX. Some of these are basic courses introducing you to the field, while others are advanced and require proficiency in a programming language.

Coursera -

- Duke University - Data Analysis and Statistical Inference - 2 months - http://dgit.in/DukeStat
- John Hopkins University - Data Science Specialisation - 9 months - http://dgit.in/JHopkins
- National Research University - Core Concepts in Data Analysis - 2 months - http://dgit.in/HSECore
- University of Washington - Introduction to Data Science - 2 months - http://dgit.in/WUIntro
- University of Washington - Computational Methods for Data Analysis - 2 months - http://dgit.in/WUComp.
- University of Toronto - Statistics: Making Sense of Data - 2 months - http://dgit.in/UTDataIntro
- University of Toronto - Neural Networks for Machine Learning - 2 months - http://dgit.in/UTNeural
- Princeton University - Algorithms - 4 months - http://dgit.in/PUAlg
- Stanford University - Algorithms: Design and Analysis - 4 months - http://dgit.in/SUAlgo
- Stanford University - Machine Learning - 2 months - http://dgit.in/StanUML
- Stanford University - Probabilistic Graphical models - 2 months - http://dgit.in/StanUPGM
- Columbia University - Natural language Processing - 2 months - http://dgit.in/UCNLP

EdX -

- Karolinska Institute - Explore Statistics with R - 2 months - http://dgit.in/KIExploRx
- Caltech - Learning from Data - 2.5 months - http://dgit.in/CalTechData
- University of Texas at Austin - Foundations of Data Analysis - 3 months - http://dgit.in/UTFounData
- University of California at Berkeley - Introduction to Statistics - 3 months - http://dgit.in/UBStats
- MIT - Introduction to Computational Thinking and Data Science - 2 months - http://dgit.in/MITDS